Delivery Metrics & Tech Debt

Track how quickly and safely you deliver, keep technical debt visible, and plan time to pay it down.

Manage Flow · Inspired by DORA's Four Key Metrics · Technical Debt Quadrant (Martin Fowler)

TEAM / SYSTEM _____

DATE _____

1 Four Key Delivery Metrics

TWO FOR SPEED · TWO FOR STABILITY · TRACK THE TREND

Deployment Frequency — SPEED

How often we release to production.

3 months ago: _____

Now: _____

Target: _____

Measured from: _____

☐ Better ☐ Same ☐ Worse

Lead Time for Changes — SPEED

Time from code committed to running in production.

3 months ago: _____

Now: _____

Target: _____

Measured from: _____

☐ Better ☐ Same ☐ Worse

Change Failure Rate — STABILITY

% of releases that cause a failure needing a fix.

3 months ago: _____

Now: _____

Target: _____

Measured from: _____

☐ Better ☐ Same ☐ Worse

Recovery Time — STABILITY

Time to restore service after a failed release.

3 months ago: _____

Now: _____

Target: _____

Measured from: _____

☐ Better ☐ Same ☐ Worse

2 Tech Debt Register

THE INTEREST IS WHAT IT COSTS TO LEAVE IT

DEBT	WHERE	INTEREST: COST OF LEAVING IT	EFFORT S/M/L	TYPE	OWNER

3 Debt Quadrant

WHY THE DEBT EXISTS

DELIBERATE →

Reckless · Deliberate
"No time for design."

Prudent · Deliberate
"Ship now, fix later, knowingly."

Reckless · Inadvertent
"What's good design?"

Prudent · Inadvertent
"Now we know how we should have built it."

RECKLESS — PRUDENT

4 Time to Pay It Down

% of each iteration for debt & enablers: _____

This iteration we'll pay down: _____

5 Review

LEARN, DON'T COMPARE TEAMS

Metrics reviewed every: _____

What the trends tell us: _____

"Are we getting faster without getting less stable?"

"Which debt is costing us most every week we leave it?"

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